



Greenwich Parents & Carers

About us: Greenwich Parents & Carers (GPC) is a volunteer-run community for parents and carers of babies and young children living in and local to Greenwich, London. Founded in 2021, we bring families together to connect, share information, and support one another through the early years of parenthood. We create welcoming spaces - both online and in person - to talk about baby and child-related topics, exchange local knowledge, and organise meetups and family-friendly events. Our aim is to build a strong, supportive community that celebrates families and supports local businesses. We value inclusivity, kindness and connection.

Our journey so far: In 2021, as the UK was still navigating the Covid-19 pandemic, our founder Aster had just moved to Greenwich and was expecting her second baby. With no family or friends nearby, she began hosting weekly meetups to connect with other expectant parents. What started as a small gathering at Davy's Wine Bar soon moved outdoors to Greenwich Park and the Maritime Museum as the group grew. As babies were born, the community expanded - connected through a lively WhatsApp group and supported by a team of volunteer admins. Today, we have nearly 1,800 members and a range of peer-support groups, including Medical FAQs, SEND, Schools and Freecycle.

We remain proudly community-led, supporting members to organise activities and events. In 2024, we hosted our first Summer Fair at St Alfege Community Hall, bringing together families with children aged 0-5 and showcasing local businesses. The event attracted over 500 attendees and dozens of local traders and performers. Following its success, we became a Community Interest Company, enabling us to run events more effectively. Since then, we've delivered another Summer Fair and a sold-out Christmas Fair in 2025, launched a monthly Mums in Business & Work networking group, a free weekly What's On Guide, and our website. We've also supported wider initiatives, including the DadShift Paternity Leave campaign and a donation drive for the Lewisham Toy Library.

**What we have achieved since July 2021:**

Thriving & supportive WhatsApp Community	Regular Free/Low Cost Community Events	Major Events	Growing Digital Presence
• Nearly 1,800 members • 20 dedicated Admins Special Interest Peer-Support Groups • 5x Year Groups • Ask the Neighbours • Dad's Den • Freecycle • Local What's On • Medical FAQs • Mums in Business & Work • Schools, Nurseries • SEND • Solo Parents	Weekly Meetups • 200+ weekly meetups Mums in Business & Work • 9+ networking meetups, showcasing expert speakers (Andrea) Dads Meetup • 1x pub meetup (Oswald) Drinks Social Club • 4+ Sail Loft drinks (Ana) Social Club • 1 Mums Bowling Night (Alicia)	Summer Fair • 2024 & 2025 costing circa £1k each and making a small profit each event, 500+ attendees (Aster) Christmas Fair • 2025 costing <£1k and making a small profit, 300+ tickets sold (Alba) Dadshift Campaign • Greenwich Park (Richard) Lewisham Toy Library • 2x car-loads of donations	Weekly What's On Guide • 65+ newsletters every Friday morning • 500+ email subscribers • £180+ advertising income (Aster) Instagram @gpc.community • 900+ connections • Facebook & LinkedIn presence Website • www.gpccommunity.co.uk



GPC Strategic Plan 2026

Our Purpose: (why we exist)

To create an inclusive community that provides opportunities for parents and carers living in and local to Greenwich (London) to connect, share information and support each other.

"Creating community, celebrating families, supporting local businesses"

Our Aspirations: (what we want to achieve)

For every member of our community to feel included, connected, and supported on their parenting journey.

Our Focus Areas: (how we will get there)

1. Maintaining a community-led model that empowers members to connect and support each other
2. Maintaining and improving our trusted and valued GPC WhatsApp Community
3. Delivering a sustainable programme of quality in-person activities and events for our community
4. Growing our digital reach through our newsletter and web presence

Our Enablers: (what we will need to get us there)

1. A clear set of values that guide all of our activities
2. A team of volunteers who feel supported and who are effective
3. A sustainable governance structure, agreed policies, and transparent leadership
4. A sustainable finance model that supports our activities

Our Values: Inclusivity, Kindness, Connection

Key Goals for 2026

1. Maintain our core activity of regular weekly meetups
2. Empower more community members to organise activities and events, and engage in relevant causes
3. Expand Mums in Business to support mums returning to work
4. Broaden the scope of our Summer Fair to cater to children aged 5-8
5. Be inclusive in our language (and not inadvertently exclude Dads)
6. Grow the What's On Guide, potentially into a website or app
7. Restructure our WhatsApp Community to enable growth
8. Distribute governance and leadership responsibilities to reduce the risk of a single point of failure

Our Volunteer Leadership Team	
CIC Governance Team (and WhatsApp Admins) Aster Andrea - Mums in Business & Work Lead Clare Leah	WhatsApp Community Admins (and Advisory) Ana - Drinks Social Club Lead Alicia - Socials Co-Lead (with Abbie) Dora - Weekly Meetups Lead Evi Jennifer Jenny - Medical FAQs Lead Kirsten - Facebook Buy/Sell Lead Kristina Laura Oswald Preema Richard Robin Sarah Sharon - Blackheath Meetups Lead
Weekly Meetup Team Dora Bea Gill Jeveria Kate Kate Lizzy Marisa Sharon	Events Aster - Summer Fair Organiser Alba - Christmas Fair Organiser Abbie - Social Co-Lead (with Alicia)

WhatsApp Community Guidelines

Welcome! This community exists to connect, support, and encourage parents and carers from all backgrounds. To keep this space safe, helpful, and respectful for everyone, please follow these guidelines:

1. Be Kind and Respectful

- We welcome parents and carers from all cultures, ethnicities, religions, genders, family structures, abilities, and identities.
- Everyone's parenting journey is different; please be supportive.
- No shaming, discrimination, or judgemental language will be tolerated.
- Disagreements are healthy; please keep discussions respectful and calm.
- Ask questions with curiosity, not criticism

2. Respect Privacy & Confidentiality

- Please do not screenshot, forward, or share messages or photos with personal information outside the community without permission.
- Avoid sharing the personal contact details of others.

3. Be Mindful of Volume

- Please keep messages relevant to the group chat.
- Avoid excessive posting or putting the same posts in multiple groups.

4. No Spam or Promotion

- No advertising, selling, or self-promotion is allowed except in select group chats where it is stated in the description.
- This includes products, services, referral links, and surveys.

5. Seek Admin Support

- Community Admins are here to keep the space safe and positive.
- Admins may redirect conversations or remove content if needed.
- Repeated breaches of guidelines may result in removal from the group chat or community.

WhatsApp Admin Guidelines

Thank you for being an Admin. Admins play a valuable and important role in creating and maintaining a safe, inclusive, and respectful space for our community. Admins are held to a higher standard as our tone and behaviour sets the standard for the community. These guidelines are intended to support Admins in their role:

1. Communication & Transparency

- Always communicate with kindness, patience, and respect.
- Avoid judgemental language, sarcasm, or dismissive responses.
- Explain moderation decisions briefly and respectfully when appropriate.

2. Active Moderation

- Monitor conversations regularly to ensure guidelines are followed.
- Intervene early if discussions become heated, unsafe, or exclusionary.
- Remove misinformation, spam, or inappropriate content.
- Use private messages for gentle corrections if necessary.

3. Privacy & Confidentiality

- Protect members' privacy at all times, in compliance with GDPR.
- Remove posts that share personal information without consent.
- Remind members of confidentiality expectations if necessary.

4. Fair & Consistent Decision-Making

- Apply guidelines consistently and fairly to all members.
- Consult with other Admins before making major decisions (e.g. removing a member).

5. Conflict Management

- De-escalate conflicts calmly and neutrally.
- Encourage respectful dialogue and pause discussions if needed.
- Move sensitive conversations to private messages if necessary.
- Remove members only as a last resort after clear warnings, unless safety is at risk.

6. Admin Misconduct

- Concerns about Admin behaviour will be taken seriously.
- Admins must be open to feedback and willing to reflect and apologise when appropriate.
- Repeated unkind or judgemental behaviour by an Admin will trigger:
 - o A review with other Admins and a warning
 - o Removal from the Admin role if behaviour does not change
- Three complaints from different individuals within the community against the same Admin will trigger removal of the admin from the role

APPENDIX

Our Digital Tools and Accounts Banking - Co-op Bank Account Software & Platforms - Zeffy - Ticketing/donations platform - Brevo - Newsletter software - BuyMeACoffee (to be deactivated in favour of Zeffy) 123Reg.com - Website Email Addresses - GPC Events gpc.summerfair@gmail.com - GPC News gpc.communitynews@gmail.com - GPC Mums in Business mumsinbusinessgpc@gmail.com	Community Partnerships/Relationships Venues - St Alfege Church - Greenwich West Community Centre - Borough Hall Charity Partner - MammaKind Charity - Lewisham Toy Library Previous Event Sponsors - Mumstuary - Hartbeeps - Waves Massage - The Working Mums Club Business Partners/Supporters - Boppin Bunnies
Our Equipment - Stripe Reader x2 - Coffee Carafes x2 - Tokens - Lanyards	Grant Funding Applications (in progress) GNGF Start-up Greenwich For event items, including Banners, Mic, Speaker, Trestle Table, Gazebo